

FURNITURE / 2013 / WANTED DESIGN, NEW YORK

Solid Cast Bronze Unfolding Chair

One hundred pounds of solid bronze



The 1941 Krueger steel folding chair, cast solid in bronze and stripped of its ability to fold.

THE WORK

The 1941 Krueger steel folding chair may be the most common chair ever made: about two dollars, made from excess steel, built to fold flat and nest by the hundred, the gym assembly chair kept in high school closets. Its utility made it universal, and it never got the Eames level respect. The Unfolding Chair takes a second look at it.

THE MATERIAL QUESTION

To unfold the design is to undo the mechanism that defined it. Recast in a hundred pounds of solid bronze, the chair trades functional value for material value.

THE MAKING

The idea came out of a heated debate between Ben Stagl, Bo Rodda, Max Davis, Kuan Wen Chiu, and Jason Gillette about what to take to New York. In a kitchen, someone pointed at a folding chair and said, let's just make that in solid bronze. Who said it is still debated. Ben was running a bronze manufacturing business at the time and saw it immediately: two or three molds, manageable in the time frame.

IN PLACE

What no one anticipated was the weight, and how much it would change the experience. On the first day of WANTED DESIGN 2013, in an area curated by Cappellini, Cappellini himself was walking through straightening things up. He went to move what he thought was a standard folding chair and could not move it at all. He stepped back and laughed. The chair went on to the cover of the New York Times' Design Week coverage that year.

DETAILS

Year

2013

Location

WANTED DESIGN, New York

Category

Furniture

Materials

Solid cast bronze

CREDITS

With Bo Rodda, Jason Gillette, Max Davis, Kuan Wen Chiu

STUDIO

ChiLab Studio

Chicago, Illinois

Established 2013



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06 SOLID CAST BRONZE UNFOLDING CHAIR

**Bring us a drawing,
a model, or a hunch.**

THE STUDIO

Specialty material projects for architecture, interior design, public art, and the fine arts.

ChiLab Studio, Chicago, Illinois. Established 2013.

WHAT WE DO

Metal casting

Glass

Finishes

Digital fabrication

Metal fabrication

Restoration

Project management

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